

DIRECTIONS *for questions 1 to 4:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Before a company can charge admission, it must design an experience that customers judge to be worth the price. Yet experiences, like goods and services, have their own distinct qualities and characteristics and present their own design challenges.

One way to think about experiences is across two dimensions. The first corresponds to customer participation. At one end of the spectrum lies passive participation, in which customers don't affect the performance at all. Such participants include symphony-goers, for example, who experience the event as observers or listeners. At the other end of the spectrum lies active participation, in which customers play key roles in creating the performance or event that yields the experience. These participants include skiers. But even people who turn out to watch a ski race are not completely passive participants; simply by being there, they contribute to the visual and aural event that others experience.

The second dimension of experience describes the connection, or environmental relationship, that unites customers with the event or performance. At one end of the connection spectrum lies absorption, at the other end, immersion. People viewing the Kentucky Derby from the grandstand can absorb the event taking place beneath and in front of them; meanwhile, people standing in the infield are immersed in the sights, sounds, and smells that surround them. Furiously scribbling notes while listening to a physics lecture is more absorbing than reading a textbook; seeing a film at the theater with an audience, large screen, and stereophonic sound is more immersing than watching the same film on video at home.

We can sort experiences into four broad categories according to where they fall along the spectra of the two dimensions. The kinds of experiences most people think of as entertainment—watching television, attending a concert – tend to be those in which customers participate more passively than actively; their connection with the event is more likely one of absorption than of immersion. Educational events – attending a class, taking a ski lesson – tend to involve more active participation, but students or customers are still more outside the event than immersed in the action. Escapist experiences can teach just as well as educational events can, or amuse just as well as entertainment, but they involve greater customer immersion. Acting in a play, playing in an orchestra, or descending the Grand Canyon involve both active participation and immersion in the experience. If you minimize the customers' active participation, however, an escapist event becomes an experience of the fourth kind – the aesthetic. Here customers or participants are immersed in an activity or environment, but they themselves have little or no effect on it – like a tourist who merely views the Grand Canyon from its rim or like a visitor to an art gallery.

Generally, we find that the richest experiences – such as going to an amusement park like Disney World or gambling in a Las Vegas casino – encompass aspects of all four realms, forming a “sweet spot” around the area where the spectra meet. But still, the universe of possible experiences is vast. Eventually, the most significant question managers can ask themselves is “What specific experience will my company offer?” That experience will come to define their business.

Q1. The last line of the passage suggests that:

- ☐ a) Businesses should offer both absorbing and immersive experiences to survive.
- ☐ b) Every business must offer a unique experience to be profitable.
- ☐ c) Every business must offer an experience that justifies the price the customer pays.
- ☐ d) Businesses are characterised by the kind of experience they offer.

Q2. Which of the following is the author least likely to approve of based on the information in the passage?

- ☐ a) River rafting is an example of an activity that offers both active participation and immersion.
- ☐ b) Attending a painting class involves more active participation than immersion.
- ☐ c) Attending a yoga class where one focuses on blindly following the instructor is an aesthetic event.
- ☐ d) Playing a virtual game of tennis with your friend is an escapist event.

Q3. Which of the following statements, if true, weakens the author's conclusion from the example of the symphony-goers (second para)?

- ☐ a) A lot more goes into the quality of the symphony experience than just the musician's pedigree.
- ☐ b) The music awareness of the audience at a symphony influences the performance of the musician.
- ☐ c) Symphonies played to packed halls offer the same experience as those played in empty theatres.
- ☐ d) A symphony is best experienced by audience members who are aware of the nuances of the music played.

Q4. Which of the following statements is NOT necessarily compatible with the author's explanation of the two aspects of the second dimension of experience?

- ☐ a) Watching a cricket match at a sports bar is more immersing than watching the same match intently by oneself at home
- ☐ b) Concentrating on a lecture in a classroom is more absorbing than listening to a video recording of the same lecture
- ☐ c) Attending a concert with one's friends is more immersing than listening to the same songs on a phone app
- ☐ d) Attending a football match with friends is more absorbing than attending a football match alone

DIRECTIONS *for questions 5 to 8:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Since the early 1980s, schools have become ever more captivated by the idea that students must learn a set of generalised thinking skills to flourish in the contemporary world – and especially in the contemporary job market. Variouslly called ‘21st-century learning skills’ or ‘critical thinking’, the aim is to equip students with a set of general problem-solving approaches that can be applied to any given domain; these are lauded by business leaders as an essential set of dispositions for the 21st century. Naturally, we want children and graduates to have a set of all-purpose cognitive tools with which to navigate their way through the world. It’s a shame, then, that we’ve failed to apply any critical thinking to the question of whether any such thing can be taught.

To be good in a specific domain you need to know a lot about it: it’s not easy to translate those skills to other areas. This is even more so with the kinds of complex and specialised knowledge that accompanies much professional expertise: as later studies found, the more complex the domain, the more important domain-specific knowledge. This non-translatability of cognitive skill is well-established in psychological research and has been replicated many times. Other studies, for example, have shown that the ability to remember long strings of digits doesn’t transfer to the ability to remember long strings of letters...

In almost every arena, the higher the skill level, the more specific the expertise is likely to become. In a football team, for example, there are different ‘domains’ or positions: goalkeeper, defender, attacker. Within those, there are further categories: centre-back, full-back, attacking midfielder, holding midfielder, attacking player. At a professional level, if you put a left-back in a striker’s position or a central midfielder in goal, the players would be lost. For them to make excellent, split-second decisions, and to enact robust and effective strategies, they need thousands of specific mental models – and thousands of hours of practice to create those models – all of which are specific and exclusive to a position.

Of course, critical thinking is an essential part of a student’s mental equipment. However, it cannot be detached from context... This detachment of cognitive ideals from contextual knowledge is not confined to the learning of critical thinking. Some schools laud themselves for placing ‘21st-century learning skills’ at the heart of their mission. An example of this is brain-training games that claim to help kids become smarter, more alert and able to learn faster. However, recent research has shown that brain-training games are really only good for one thing – getting good at brain-training games. The claim that they offer students a general set of problem-solving skills was recently debunked by a study that reviewed more than 130 papers, which concluded: “[W]e know of no evidence for broad-based improvement in cognition, academic achievement, professional performance, and/or social competencies that derives from decontextualised practice of cognitive skills devoid of domain-specific content.” Instead of teaching generic critical-thinking skills, we ought to focus on subject-specific critical-thinking skills that seek to broaden a student’s individual subject knowledge and unlock the unique, intricate mysteries of each subject.

Q5. The purpose of the last sentence of the second para is to elucidate the conclusion that:

- ☐ a) Cognitive skills in one domain are ineffective in another.
- ☐ b) Domain-specific knowledge cannot be achieved through training in generic skills.
- ☐ c) Cognitive skills are not a substitute for complex and specialized knowledge.
- ☒ d) **The translatability of generic cognitive skills to a specific domain cannot be replicated across other domains.** ✖ Your answer is incorrect

Q6. All of the following, if true, enhance the reliability of the study mentioned in the last para of the passage EXCEPT:

- ☐ a) It is possible to compare the success of those who have had decontextualised practice of generic cognitive skills and those who have not had such practice.
- ☒ b) **It is possible to train individuals in cognitive skills without domain-specific content.** ✖ **Your answer is incorrect**
- ☐ c) It is possible to identify the link between training in decontextualised cognitive skills and the outcomes in specific domains.
- ☐ d) **It is possible to offer cognitive skills that take the context of a specific domain into account.**

Q7. In the passage, the author says, 'In almost every arena, the higher the skill level, the more specific the expertise is likely to become.' Which of the following will weaken the above statement?

- ☒ a) In a corporate office, roles higher up the hierarchy are specifically tailored to individual skillsets that individuals can be specifically trained to learn. **✗ Your answer is incorrect**
- ☐ b) Elite athletes in team sports are given specific mandates about all the roles they play in the team.
- ☐ c) In startups, individuals learn to perform multiple tasks, because of lack of resources, getting more skilful at each of them with time.
- ☐ d) Individuals with good decision-making and critical thinking skills tend to upskill faster in professional domains.

Q8. Which of the following is the author's central argument in the passage?

- ☐ a) **People who are good at one domain may not be good at other domains.**
- ☐ b) **Teaching students generic thinking skills which are independent of the rest of their curriculum is meaningless and ineffective.**
- ☐ c) Decontextualised practice of cognitive skills devoid of domain-specific content does more harm than good in the long run.
- ☐ d) **A generalised set of problem-solving approaches doesn't teach students how to think critically.**

DIRECTIONS *for questions 9 to 12:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The Levellers are a hidden gem from British history. They were a mid-17th century group in England, who participated in debates about democracy that took place in a part of London called Putney. Their achievement was crafting “An Agreement of the People,” which were a series of manifestos that marked the first popular conceptions of what a constitutional democracy might look like.

The Levellers are interesting for two reasons. First, in the context of the time, their approach was constructive and practical. The “Agreement” spells out what people want from those who govern them in a clear and tangible way. For example, they proposed term limits on political office and that laws regarding indebtedness are applied equally to the rich and poor.

Second, they are interesting for the way the movement was countermanded and then snuffed out by the military leader Oliver Cromwell and the Grandees (the elites of their day). Like so many idealistic political start-ups, the Levellers failed. This should encourage the growing number of new political parties, like Change UK and new candidates to be worldly-wise in how they approach the process of political reform and change.

A lot is made of the Cold War rivalry between communist Russia and America, and now some want to see a clash of civilizations between America and China. The “Levelling” characterises a future where there are at least two approaches to public life. The most distinctive approach to nations doing things in their own way will be for what the Levellers might call the “rights of freeborn men,” or the idea of the open society. The code of the Levellers presents a very clear political formula that Europeans and Americans will recognise for its values, though decreasingly in its practice.

The challenge to this code will come from the rising acceptance of less democratic ways of ordering society, in both developed and developing countries. A related clash will be the desire of a growing proportion of electorates to have a more open society as economies also open up.

As the world evolves along the lines of Leveller-type and Leviathan-type societies, it is possible that in some countries, such as Russia, a Leviathan-like approach—that is, order in exchange for reduced democracy and rights—will be the accepted way of life. In other countries, most interestingly China, as its economy loses momentum and evolves, there may be a growing tension between groups holding the Leviathan view (supported inevitably by Grandees) and opposing Leveller-like groups (who favor equality of opportunity and a multiparty system). The role and views of women, especially in China, and of minority groups like the gay community will be pivotal.

The emergence of a new world order, based on large regions and coloured by Leveller and Leviathan modes of governance, echoes several periods in history. The challenge in the next few years will be for Leviathan-oriented nations like China to maintain economic stability so that rising unemployment, for instance, does not break the “Leviathan contract”. Equally, the challenge in Leveller countries will be to maintain open, fraternal societies in the face of political and potentially economic volatility.

Q9. The Leviathan-view and the Leveller-view societies are different in that the

- ☐ a) **former prefers order over freedom, whereas the latter prefers the reverse.**
- ☐ b) **former compromises democracy and rights for order, whereas the latter doesn't.**
- ☐ c) former promises political stability whereas the latter promises economic stability.
- ☐ d) **former is supported by the common man, whereas the latter is supported by the Grandees.**

Q10. The author's advice to China would be that

- ☐ a) it should move to a multi-party system.
- ☐ b) it should offer greater rights to women and the gay community.
- ☐ c) it should try to maintain open, fraternal societies in the face of economic instability.
- ☐ d) it should keep unemployment below the threshold that threatens its order.

Q11. The author's opinion about the challenges facing Leveller-type societies is weakened by which of the following?

- ☐ a) **The stability of Leveller-type political systems is dependent on the economic prosperity of the country.**
- ☐ b) **The economic stability of Leveller-type societies is tightly coupled with their political stability.**
- ☐ c) The political and economic volatilities of Leveller-type societies do not affect their open and fraternal nature.
- ☐ d) **The economic stability of Leveller-type societies is only loosely coupled with their political stability.**

Q12. The distinction the author draws up between Russia and China is that

- ☐ a) **Russia has a Leviathan-like approach, whereas China swings between Leviathan and Leveller orientations.**
- ☐ b) **in Russia, the Leviathan-approach holds sway, whereas in China the economic momentum swings power from Leviathans to Levellers.**
- ☐ c) Russia's order depends on its Leviathan-type approach, whereas China's economic slowdown fuels the tension between Leviathan and Leveller groups.
- ☐ d) **in Russia it is acceptable for order to be maintained in exchange for reduced democracy and rights, but in China the order depends on economic momentum.**

DIRECTIONS *for questions 13 to 16:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Since the Renaissance, when revolutionaries like Giotto and Brunelleschi used one-point perspective to project the seen world onto the canvas, painting was traditionally devoted towards reproducing vision as it's captured by the human eye. The collective aim of the medium was to present scenes from life and history with total realism. Today, however, we take for granted that a canvas does not have to faithfully reflect the way we see the world, and that a painting has its own internal rationality: a vocabulary of colour, shape, and texture that provides a roadmap for the viewer's eye. In other words, the vision that the painter presents his or his work does not have to be a literal one—a leap forward for the potentialities of art. How did this remarkable shift occur?

In the early 20th century, encouraged by an aesthetic revisiting of what were then still considered "primitive" arts—most prominently those of Africa and Asia—and spurred on by rapid developments in photography in the late 19th century, which alleviated painting of its need to faithfully depict the natural world, European artists began experimenting with abstraction, shattering conventional notions of the function of artistic composition. The artists most closely associated with so-called Cubism's conception are Pablo Picasso and Georges Braque, who collaboratively (and secretly) developed the concepts behind the movement beginning in 1907...

Many historians credit Picasso's *Les Femmes d'Alger* (O.J. no. 1) as the foundational work of Cubism, and, thus, of all Modern Art. It shows a radical shift of perspective, showing two views of a scene at once; this was unprecedented in painting at the time. The achievements of one-point perspective had been a drastic step forward in pictorial representation, and here was Picasso, undoing it all. [Understandably] Matisse called the work "the death of painting."

... Between 1907 and 1912—the period of so-called Analytic Cubism—Picasso's and Braque's paintings became almost indistinguishable as they together developed a street-level colour palette limited to off-whites, greys, browns, and blacks, and stark, angular forms that were meant to appeal to the viewer's intellect rather than to their emotions, emulating the way images are formed in the brain rather than the eye and depicting multiple viewpoints at once. The pair eschewed beauty or idealized forms in favour of an entirely new investigative approach to their medium. It was what Metzinger referred to as a "total emancipation" ('*affranchissement fondamentale*') of painting.

Between 1913 and the 1920s, the initial developments of Analytic Cubism were expanded into what came to be called Synthetic Cubism, which emphasized the synthesis of the elements of the composition and introduced the idea of collaging elements onto the canvas—pieces of rope, cigar papers, and so on — and further breaking down the relationship between the surface of the painting and its subject matter.

...From its entrance onto the global public stage, Cubism was a contentiously debated movement, and as such fully codified art's new function in Modern society: its tendency to get people talking, the more heatedly the better... Cubism, a revolt of the mind against decorative frivolity, left its major legacy in art history in the lasting idea that perception is a fluid, mutable thing that is not only governed by our biology or physiology, but can actually be created anew within, and then projected from, objects of art...

Q13. Which of the following wasn't discussed as a contributing factor for the rise of Cubism and Modern Art?

- ☐ a) **A streak of rebellion against established conventions by avant-garde artists**
- ☐ b) **The handing over of the responsibility to depict reality as captured by the human eye to photography**
- ☐ c) The discovery of the aesthetics of Asian and African arts
- ☐ d) **A change in stance towards hitherto ignored styles of arts**

Q14. Metzinger used the remark 'Affranchissement fondamentale' to probably highlight that Cubism

- ☐ a) **was completely freed of colour.**
- ☐ b) **was unchained from the image one perceives beyond the eye.**
- ☐ c) was drained of all idealized forms of beauty.
- ☐ d) **rejected the established norms in painting.**

Q15. Picasso's Les Demoiselles d'Avignon was called 'the death of painting' by Matisse most probably because

- ☐ a) **it represented a drastic shift from all the conventions of pictorial representation.**
- ☐ b) **it dismantled the progress that painting achieved through the single-perspective approach.**
- ☐ c) it involved creative perspectives that were never imagined in painting before.
- ☐ d) **it did irreversible damage to the foundational work of painting.**

Q16. Which of the following statements is most justified regarding the controversy that surrounded Cubism as discussed in the last para of the passage?

- ☐ a) **The controversy fulfils the purpose of art in Modern society.**
- ☐ b) **The controversy was inevitable given Cubism's disinclination to established norms.**
- ☐ c) The controversy was the expected response of purists against Cubism's revolt.
- ☐ d) **The controversy was testimony to the fact that Cubism instigates intellect.**

Q17. DIRECTIONS *for questions 17 and 18:* The paragraph given below is followed by four summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the paragraph.

If equality of educational opportunity can be established, democracy will be real and justified. For this is the vital truth beneath its catchwords: that though humans cannot be equal, their access to education and opportunity can be made more nearly equal. The rights of humans are not rights to office and power, but the rights of entry into every avenue that may nourish and test their fitness for office and power. A right is not a gift of God or nature but a privilege which is good for the group that the individual should have.

- ☐ a) **Democracy will be justified when there is equal access to educational opportunity enabling everyone's right to prepare for office.**
- ☒ b) **Democracy demands for every individual the right to educational opportunity and access to any office that tests their fitness for power.** ✖ **Your answer is incorrect**
- ☐ c) Democracy rests on the assumption that when humans enjoy equal access to education and opportunity, they become equal.
- ☐ d) **Democracy is justified when humans who are not created equal enjoy equal access to education and opportunity.**

Q18. DIRECTIONS *for questions 17 and 18:* The paragraph given below is followed by four summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the paragraph.

The appearance of new technology signifies the move from the industrial society to the knowledge and information society, and this transformation means a radical change in the way companies are managed. The knowledge society demands a new focus and a new vision of how organizations should be managed. And companies have come to two conclusions about this new focus; that the person is the major asset, and the company cannot be alien to the environment in which it lives and develops. The company's ability to assimilate and take advantage of these ideas is fundamental to its ability to be efficient and profitable in today's world.

- ☐ a) In the knowledge society, people who work for a company and the environments in which such companies evolve determine the profitability.
- ☐ b) Companies have finally realised that they should focus on people and environments in today's knowledge society.
- ☒ c) New technology signifies a knowledge society where companies have to recognize the value of people and environments to be profitable. ✓ **Your answer is correct**
- ☐ d) Knowledge societies rely on new technologies that help a company focus on its environment and employees better.

Q19. DIRECTIONS *for question 19:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Pick the option that represents the most logical and coherent order for the four sentences.

1. A work of art is not a message that encodes for emotions any more than a sunset is, and there is no correct way of interpreting either.
2. It involves following, altering, breaking and making up the rules as you go along, and those rules or principles are meaningful only in relation to the organised sound, and vice versa.
3. In fact, the hallmark of great art is that we all perceive it personally and differently.
4. Listening to a piece of music, quite like writing one, is a creative act: both are part of an 'acoustic language game' in the Wittgensteinian sense, whose ultimate frame of reference is itself.

- ☐ a) 1342
- ☐ b) 4213
- ☒ c) 1234 **✗ Your answer is incorrect**
- ☐ d) 1423

Q20. DIRECTIONS *for question 20:* The paragraph given below is followed by four summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the paragraph.

Organizing is not a process of ideological matchmaking. Most people's politics will not mirror our own, and even people who identify with us strongly on some points will often differ sharply on others. When organizers do not fully understand each other's beliefs or identities, people will often stumble and offend one another, even if they earnestly wish to build from a place of solidarity. Efforts to build diverse, intergenerational movements will always generate conflict and discomfort. But the desire to shrink groups down to spaces of easy agreement is not conducive to movement building.

- ☐ a) **Organising involves building from a place of solidarity, but movements involve building places where people offend each other at times.**
- ☐ b) **Diverse movements will witness conflict and disagreement, but weeding out conflict isn't helpful for building movements.**
- ☐ c) **Not all movements have people who agree with each other completely, but sometimes conflict helps diversity of the movement.**
- ☐ d) **The failure of organisers to understand each other's beliefs leads to conflict and disagreement between those who are part of the same movement.**

Q21. DIRECTIONS *for questions 21 and 22:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Pick the option that represents the most logical and coherent order for the four sentences.

- 1. The concept of peaceful coexistence was modified, and the notion of class warfare eliminated from the Soviet political lexicon.
- 2. The essence of new Soviet thinking was stated to lie in the priority of universal human values and the resolution of global problems, which is directly linked to the growing importance of international law in the world community.
- 3. Global interdependence and the necessity for international co-operation were emphasised, as it was accepted that the tension between capitalism and socialism no longer constituted the major conflict in the contemporary world and that beneath the former dogmas lay many common interests.
- 4. With the decline of the Cold War and the onset of perestroika (restructuring) in the Soviet Union, a process of re-evaluation in the field of international legal theory took place.

- ☐ a) **2134**
- ☐ b) **4132**
- ☐ c) **2314**
- ☐ d) **4321**

Q22. DIRECTIONS *for questions 21 and 22:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Pick the option that represents the most logical and coherent order for the four sentences.

1. In contrast, French revolutionaries, a few years later, had beheaded the king, queen and thousands more, and abolished the feudal system.

2. It's hard to say for sure why specific places weren't renamed, but overall, the American Revolution brought limited change.

3. After the war, America began rebuilding economic and diplomatic ties with Britain.

4. From the outset, many colonists opposed it or were indifferent.

☐ a) **3241**

☐ b) **3124**

☐ c) **2134**

☐ d) **2431**

Q23. DIRECTIONS *for questions 23 and 24:* There is a sentence that is missing in the paragraph below. Look at the paragraph and decide in which blank (blank 1, 2, 3, 4, or 5) the given sentence would best fit. Enter the number of the blank in the text box provided below.

Sentence: *Hiring a sizeable cohort also reinforces to the company at large that skills-first approaches are integral, not superfluous.*

Paragraph: _____(1)_____. The cohort experience is critical for both nontraditional hires and the colleagues they join. _____(2)_____. New employees without four-year degrees need to see that the organization is investing in workers like them, not timidly experimenting around the edges. _____(3)_____. And in an environment where they may fear being viewed as unqualified or feel out of place, having a community of similar peers can bolster confidence and connection. _____(4)_____ One or two people are likely to languish if they don't seamlessly fit into an organizational culture where their value is underrecognized, but a robust cohort can precipitate changes to the culture itself. _____(5)_____

Q24. DIRECTIONS *for questions 23 and 24:* There is a sentence that is missing in the paragraph below. Look at the paragraph and decide in which blank (blank 1, 2, 3, 4, or 5) the given sentence would best fit. Enter the number of the blank in the text box provided below.

Sentence: *Egypt led the Arab world in these fields, although it took a full century before photography was officially recognized as an art form.*

Paragraph: _____(1)_____. At the dawn of the twentieth century, Egyptians, burdened with centuries of foreign occupation, were united in their aspiration for a modern nation. _____(2)_____. Thus, modern art was an essential visual expression of their national identity and freedom from foreign oppression. It was a manifestation of the contemporaneous intellectual discourse led by secular liberals, among them writers, poets, and artists, male and female. _____(3)_____. The acceptance of figuration and the introduction of art education in schools were sanctioned by religious scholars. _____(4)_____. This tolerant attitude toward figurative art was also the outcome of new developments in publishing and photography, as well as the revolutionary establishment of a local film industry. _____(5)_____.